

Phase 1: Candidate Ideas and Interview Questions

CS 5388: Software Project Management - Sprint 1

Team: Samuel Alderete, Jazmin Huerta, Christian Lopez-Matulesy, Emmanuel Saenz and Oscar Vargas.

App Candidate 1: Money already spoken for

App 1 (Finance). Combines the subscription and debt problems.

Problem statement: People don't know how much of their income is already committed to recurring charges and debt payments, so they overspend on what's left and stay in debt longer.

Questions

- Tell me about the last time you tried to create a budgeting plan that ended up not working.
- What were you trying to accomplish with that plan?
- What made the plan difficult to follow?
- What was the most frustrating or tedious part to follow about the plan?
- How do you currently keep track of recurring expenses, subscriptions, bills, or debt payment?

App Candidate 2: Eating toward a body goal

App 2 (Nutrition)

Problem statement: People trying to bulk, cut, or maintain can't tell in advance whether the day's meals will hit their macro targets, so they log after the fact, fall short, and stop tracking.

Questions

- Can you tell me about the last time you tried to lose or gain weight? Was there a body goal you had set for yourself?
- Tell me about the last time you tracked what you ate. How long did you keep it up?
- What made you stop?
- Walk me through how you decided what to eat yesterday. Did your goal factor into it?
- Tell me about the last time you hit a target for a full week. What was different that week?
- Tell me about the last time you realized at the end of a day that you'd fallen short.

App Candidate 3: Entertainment/Events Tracker

App 3 (Entertainment)

Problem statement: People find it hard to find events/places to go to in El Paso/Juarez often finding out after the events have already happened.

Questions

- Tell me about the last event you went to in the El Paso/Juarez area. How did you hear about it?
- Where do you usually look when you want to find something to do on weekends/when you have free time? **Follow up question:** Did you always know where to look? How did you find these resources?
- Is it easy to find things to do or places to go that are of your interest? Tell me about your experience. **Follow up question:** Do you think they exist, but you just don't hear about them?
- Tell me about the last time you told someone else about an event. How did you find that event?
- Think about a time when you found out about an event too late, why do you think that happened? **Follow up question:** How often does this happen to you?

App Candidate 4: Market Master

App 4 (Finance)

Problem statement: Nearly half of Americans do not hold any investment assets, and the primary reasons for not investing highlights a major educational gap.

Questions

- How many investment assets do you own?
- What do you know about the stock market?
- How much capital do you think it takes to invest in the stock market?
- What's your biggest concern or fear about investing in the stock market?
- Have you ever used an investing education app before? If so, what did you like or dislike about it?
- What would motivate you to use an investing education app regularly?

App Candidate 5: Searching across streaming services

App 5 (Entertainment)

Problem statement: People who pay for three or more streaming services have no single place to search across them, so finding one title means checking Netflix, then Hulu, then Peacock, then Max one at a time, and they often give up or pay to rent something a service they already subscribe to carries.

Questions

- How many streaming services are you paying for right now?
- When was the last time you cancelled one? What made you cancel?
- Tell me about the last time you gave up on finding something to watch and did something else instead.
- Walk me through how you found the last new show you started.
- Tell me about the last time you rented or bought something digitally instead of watching it on a service you already pay for. What led to that?
- What's the last app or website you used to figure out where a movie was streaming?
- Tell me about the last disagreement in your household about what to watch. How did it get settled?

App Candidate 1 (Finance Tracker): Interview Responses

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview #1

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Emmanuel Saenz		
Date	09-05-2026	Time	5:34
Location	Fort Worth, Texas, Eagle Ranch		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Finance Budgeting App tracker

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Warehouse worker
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How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Personal Finance
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Tell me about the last time you tried to create a budgeting plan that ended up not working?

Q2. What were you trying to accomplish with that plan?

Q3. What made the plan difficult to follow?

Q4. What was the most frustrating or tedious part to follow about the plan?

Q5. How do you currently keep track of recurring expenses, subscriptions, bills, or debt payments?

• Follow-Up Probes

Follow up: Can you tell me more about the spreadsheet and how it worked?

“I don’t really remember too well how it worked or what formulas it used, but the sheet used some formula to calculate the expenses you made for the month by category. Like I previously said, I got tired of having to manually jot down all the expenses for the month.”

Closing

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided.

☐ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“So back in around February, um, I got motivated to create a spreadsheet by using those templates they provide for you, as a way to keep track of my personal finances. The excel sheets provided a way to track income, rent and car expenses, and other stuff. First week or two I was actually tracking everything, however by the third week I ended up getting lazy and just stopped.”

“Honestly, I was just trying to track my finances as a way to see what areas I was spending the most in. Sometimes I get buy things that aren’t essentials, so I thought using a spreadsheet might of helped me manage those spending habits and pay for bills that actually needed to be payed.”

“Mostly updating the spreadsheet everyday and having to record my expenses became a hassle.”

“I would say definitely recording every purchase I made and place it in the corresponding category.”

“Mostly I just following the 50-30-20 split, I think those are the exact numbers, where save only 20% and spend the other on wants and needs. Sometimes I’m consistent and other time I’m not, it just really depends on what purchases or payments I need to make for the month.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Individual used excel spreadsheet to manually track expenses but lost motivation after a while.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 2

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Emmanuel Saenz		
Date	09-05-2026	Time	5:57
Location	Fort Worth, Texas, Eagle Ranch		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Finance Budgeting App tracker

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Financial Advisor
How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Personal Finance / Work Finance
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Tell me about the last time you tried to create a budgeting plan that ended up not working?

Q2. What were you trying to accomplish with that plan?

Q3. What made the plan difficult to follow?

Q4. What was the most frustrating or tedious part to follow about the plan?

Q5. How do you currently keep track of recurring expenses, subscriptions, bills, or debt payments?

• Follow-Up Probes

What app did you use?

"I used copilot."

Closing

☐ Asked "Who else should I talk to about this?"

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

[REDACTED]

☐ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

"Last year I tried switching from a budgeting app I normally use to a spreadsheet to have more control over what categories I could track. I ended up creating a spreadsheet with like 15 categories, but after a month, I got busier like usual and I didn't have the time to categorize every transaction I did. I ended falling of track and decided to stop using it."

"I wanted more granularity over spending. I usually advise clients on stuff all day. I wanted to see exactly how much was going into dining compared to groceries and find patterns in my spending habits. Luckily, I don't have any debt, but I still try to find ways to view patterns and spending habits."

"Manually categorizing things. I wanted more control on the way the app could categorize things."

"Just sitting down every other day and having to go through my purchases to categorize them in the sheet."

"I went back to using the budgeting app that is auto synced with my accounts. It automatically give me metrics and categorizes things for me, however I wanted to go more in depth with my finances, but got lazy."

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Finance professional did not stick with manual categorization since it required daily manual updating.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 3

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Emmanuel Saenz		
Date	09-05-2026	Time	6:22
Location	Fort Worth, Texas, Eagle Ranch		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Finance Budgeting App tracker

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Contracting company – stair construction
How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Personal Finance / Business Finance
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Tell me about the last time you tried to create a budgeting plan that ended up not working?

Q2. What were you trying to accomplish with that plan?

Q3. What made the plan difficult to follow?

Q4. What was the most frustrating or tedious part to follow about the plan?

Q5. How do you currently keep track of recurring expenses, subscriptions, bills, or debt payments?

Follow-Up Probes

What happened next?

“I was stuck with just using my own spreadsheet since the apps I looked into felt built for people with salary.”

Closing

☐ Asked “Who else should I talk to about this?”

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided.

☐ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“I don’t really have one, I’ve always been consistent with tracking all the business and personal expenses I have. Since my business expenses can be tax exempted, I try to always stay on top of it. This way I can list my purchases as either personal expenses or business expenses and hand it to my tax advisor. It also helps with listing all the owed expenses from customers, construction sites, and material bought. “

“I was trying to get consistent with tracking all the expenses I made each month. Since I don’t really receive the same paycheck each month, it helps me understand and keep track where money is being spent or invested.”

“I haven’t really had any issues other than having to manually write down all expenses. I’ve tried to look into apps that can handle this for me, but they seem too complicated for me to learn and I’d rather just stick to a simple excel sheet I created and understand.”

“Just having to manually write down all the expense I have made. I’m pretty familiar with using excel and creating formulas so I don’t really have too much of an issue using it.”

“I just use a simple spreadsheet I made that tracks expenses and revenue by each month.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Individual tracks additional expenses from his business, and did not find budgeting apps too useful.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 4

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Emmanuel Saenz		
Date	09-05-2026	Time	6:38

Location	Fort Worth, Texas, Eagle Ranch		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Finance Budgeting App tracker

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Mechanical Engineer
How they were reached	In person -
Relevant experience with the problem area	Personal Finance
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Tell me about the last time you tried to create a budgeting plan that ended up not working?

Q2. What were you trying to accomplish with that plan?

Q3. What made the plan difficult to follow?

Q4. What was the most frustrating or tedious part to follow about the plan?

Q5. How do you currently keep track of recurring expenses, subscriptions, bills, or debt payments?

Follow-Up Probes

How did that affect you: “Nothing too crazy. I think if I had loans and debt, I would probably make an effort to track those and stay on top of the payments.”

Closing

☐ Asked “Who else should I talk to about this?”

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

☐ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“Well I once used a budgeting app that puts your personal expenses categories. It was pretty convenient, but I didn’t really want to pay the monthly subscription. I personally don’t have any issues with keeping track of my finances so I don’t really use it as much as I would. Either way I have a discover credit card and it already track categorizes my purchases for free.”

“I just wanted a fancier to track all the purchases I made and see how I could help myself with investing and savings more.”

“I wasn’t difficult, it was more paying for something that I knew I could just do by myself and eyeball it. If I want to invest or save, my back account offer simple metrics that I can take a look and help me watch my money grow.”

“Nothing really, it was more just a personal thing. I’m a little lazy to track my finances the way an app would, but either way I don’t have any issues with overspending other than the necessities.”

“I just frequently check my accounts. I have very few so it’s easier for me to look over what purchases I have been making and how much my savings and investment accounts have been growing. I don’t have any student loans or debts that I have to pay. The only debts I have is my car loan but I have a good habit of not making purchases that are not necessary.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Individual relies on built in credit card categorization and simple metrics.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 5

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Emmanuel Saenz		
Date	09-05-2026	Time	6:57
Location	Fort Worth, Texas, Eagle Ranch		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Finance Budgeting App tracker

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Registered Nurse
How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Personal Finance
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Tell me about the last time you tried to create a budgeting plan that ended up not working?

Q2. What were you trying to accomplish with that plan?

Q3. What made the plan difficult to follow?

Q4. What was the most frustrating or tedious part to follow about the plan?

Q5. How do you currently keep track of recurring expenses, subscriptions, bills, or debt payments?

Follow-Up Probes

Can you tell more the envelope idea:

“Sure, it’s like a booklet thingy that contains ziplocks where you can put money. Each ziplock has a category depending on where you want to add money. I saw it once on Tiktok and thought it looked pretty cute.”

Closing

☐ Asked “Who else should I talk to about this?”

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided

☐ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

“I once tried using a personal budgeting template from excel but I got tired of having to manually write down every purchase I did or money I saved. What I decided to do to start saving more was to only spend 70% on my monthly income on bills and personal things, while saving the other 30%. I bought a money savings booklet from amazon where you can put bills into little envelopes that contain categories like “car”, “vacation”, “phone”, etc. That’s what I mainly use now.”

“Mainly trying to save money. I also wanted to see where I was spending money, but since I work on a salary, my income is the same. So I new what I could do was simply spend 70% of each paycheck in bills and other things, and then using the other 30% and saving it as cash.”

“Having to write down every expense was the difficult part, however for saving money, it was easier and more fun to visually see my money being placed in a booklet where I can see the physical money being places in a category. “

“Having to pull the cash out from an ATM is the tedious part I would say. I typically remember how much money I allocate per category, however sometimes my booklet starts getting bulky, and so I have to deposit back the money in a savings account.”

“ I still use a savings sheet, but instead of writing the expenses, I just write down the money in each category. When the envelope gets too think, I pull the money out, count it, and then place it into a savings account. I then quickly go to the excel sheet and add the money counted for in its category. I don’t know, for me this seems more fun and entertaining for tracking money.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Individual replaced expense – logging with a physical cash zip lock system paired with a simple spreadsheet.

App Candidate 2 (Eating Toward a Body Goal): Interview Responses

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 1

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Samuel Alderete		
Date	09-03-2026	Time	1:20 PM
Location	UTEP Campus		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Nutrition / Eating toward a body goal

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	College student who regularly goes to the gym
How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Has attempted to lose weight while tracking calories and protein
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Can you tell me about the last time you tried to lose or gain weight? Was there a body goal you had set for yourself?

“The last time was earlier this year. I wanted to lose around 15 pounds while keeping as much muscle as possible. I was going to the gym around four or five times a week, so I was mainly trying to eat less calories while keeping my protein high.”

Q2: Tell me about the last time you tracked what you ate. How long did you keep it up?

“I used MyFitnessPal and tracked almost everything I ate for about three weeks. The first week I was really consistent with it, but after that I started forgetting to enter meals.”

Q3: What made you stop?

“It just got annoying having to enter every ingredient and figure out the serving size. If I ate at a restaurant or somebody else cooked, I usually had no idea what the calories were, so eventually I stopped tracking.”

Q4: Walk me through how you decided what to eat yesterday. Did your goal factor into it?

“I knew I wanted something with protein, so I had eggs in the morning and chicken later in the day. My goal definitely affects what I pick, but I don't really plan the whole day ahead. I mostly decide when I'm already hungry.”

Q5: Tell me about the last time you hit a target for a full week. What was different that week?

“The best week I had was when I meal prepped everything on Sunday. I already knew what I was eating for lunch and dinner, so it was way easier to stay around my calories and protein.”

Q6: Tell me about the last time you realized at the end of a day that you'd fallen short.

“That happened a lot with protein. I would check the app at night and realize I was still like 40 grams short, but by then I didn't really want to eat another whole meal.”

▪ Follow-Up Probes

Follow-Up Probe: What usually causes you to miss your protein goal?

“Mostly not planning earlier. If I don't eat much protein in the morning, I end up trying to make up for all of it at night.”

Closing

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided

☒ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“I mostly decide when I'm already hungry.”

“I would check the app at night and realize I was still like 40 grams short.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Participant frequently discovers too late in the day that they are below their protein target and finds consistent tracking difficult without meal preparation.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 2

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Samuel Alderete		
Date	09-04-2026	Time	3:45 PM
Location	Outside a construction site		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Nutrition / Eating toward a body goal

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Construction worker who strength trains
How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Has attempted to gain weight and muscle while working a physically demanding job
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Can you tell me about the last time you tried to lose or gain weight? Was there a body goal you had set for yourself?

“I’ve been trying to gain weight for a while. My goal was to get from around 170 to 185 pounds without just putting on a bunch of fat. The hardest thing for me has actually been eating enough.”

Q2: Tell me about the last time you tracked what you ate. How long did you keep it up?

“I tracked my food for maybe two weeks. I was using an app and trying to hit around 3,000 calories every day along with my protein.”

Q3: What made you stop?

“I stopped because my work schedule changes a lot. Some days I have time to eat and some days we're busy all day. Once I missed a couple meals, I stopped caring about entering everything into the app.”

Q4: Walk me through how you decided what to eat yesterday. Did your goal factor into it?

“Yesterday I ate something quick before work and then got a burrito during lunch. When I got home I ate whatever was already made. I think about gaining weight, but I don't really know before I eat everything whether it's going to be enough for the day.”

Q5: Tell me about the last time you hit a target for a full week. What was different that week?

“I had one week where I did really good because I brought food with me every day. I had rice, chicken, snacks and protein shakes already ready. I didn't have to figure it out while I was working.”

Q6: Tell me about the last time you realized at the end of a day that you'd fallen short.

“There have been days where I check at night and I'm still 700 or 800 calories under. At that point I'm already full or tired and don't feel like forcing myself to eat.”

• Follow-Up Probes

Follow-Up Probe: Would knowing earlier in the day that you were falling behind make a difference?

“Yeah, because if I knew after lunch that I was way behind, I could add a shake or bigger dinner instead of finding out before I go to bed.”

Closing

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided

☒ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“I don't really know before I eat everything whether it's going to be enough for the day.”

“If I knew after lunch that I was way behind, I could add a shake or bigger dinner.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Participant struggles to eat enough while bulking because an unpredictable work schedule makes meal planning difficult and calorie shortages are often discovered late.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 3

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Samuel Alderete		
Date	09-05-2026	Time	11:10 AM
Location	Gym		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Nutrition / Eating toward a body goal

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Recreational gym-goer
How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Has tracked macros while trying to maintain weight and improve body composition
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Can you tell me about the last time you tried to lose or gain weight? Was there a body goal you had set for yourself?

“I wasn't really trying to gain or lose a lot of weight. I wanted to stay about the same weight but lose some fat and look more defined.”

Q2: Tell me about the last time you tracked what you ate. How long did you keep it up?

“I tracked everything for about a month. I was pretty serious about it at first and weighed most of my food.”

Q3: What made you stop?

“I got tired of having to measure everything. It started making eating feel like homework. I still pay attention to protein now, but I don't log every meal anymore.”

Q4: Walk me through how you decided what to eat yesterday. Did your goal factor into it?

“Yesterday I had oatmeal and eggs for breakfast, then I went out for lunch and had a burger. Dinner was chicken and rice. I definitely think about my goal when I eat, but it's more estimating now instead of actually tracking.”

Q5: Tell me about the last time you hit a target for a full week. What was different that week?

“The weeks where I was most consistent were when I ate almost the same meals every day. Once I already knew the macros in the meal, I didn't have to keep calculating everything.”

Q6: Tell me about the last time you realized at the end of a day that you'd fallen short.

“I remember checking one night and I had eaten enough calories but barely any protein. I didn't realize it because most of what I ate that day was snacks and food from restaurants.”

▪ Follow-Up Probes

Follow-Up Probe: What would make tracking easier for you?

“Probably being able to plan the meals first instead of entering everything after I already ate it.”

Closing

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided

☒ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“It started making eating feel like homework.”

“Probably being able to plan the meals first instead of entering everything after I already ate it.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Participant stopped detailed macro tracking because it became tedious and would prefer planning meals and projected macros before eating.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 4

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Samuel Alderete		
Date	09-06-2026	Time	2:30 PM
Location	Gym		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Nutrition / Eating toward a body goal

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Registered nurse who exercises regularly
How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Has attempted weight loss while working long and irregular shifts
Consent to take notes given?	Yes

Consent to follow up later?	Yes
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Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Can you tell me about the last time you tried to lose or gain weight? Was there a body goal you had set for yourself?

“The last goal I had was losing about 10 pounds. I wasn't trying to do anything extreme, mostly just eat better and stay in a calorie deficit.”

Q2: Tell me about the last time you tracked what you ate. How long did you keep it up?

“I tracked for maybe a week and a half. I downloaded an app and entered my meals, but once my work week started getting busy I stopped doing it consistently.”

Q3: What made you stop?

“My shifts are long and I don't always get to eat at the same time. Sometimes I'll bring food and sometimes I'll just get whatever is available. Trying to log everything during a 12-hour shift wasn't realistic for me.”

Q4: Walk me through how you decided what to eat yesterday. Did your goal factor into it?

“Yesterday I worked, so I ate something small before leaving, brought a snack and then bought lunch. My weight goal affected what I chose, but convenience affected it more because I only had so much time.”

Q5: Tell me about the last time you hit a target for a full week. What was different that week?

“The week I did the best was when I prepared my lunches and snacks before my work week started. I knew what was in everything and didn't have to make decisions at work.”

Q6: Tell me about the last time you realized at the end of a day that you'd fallen short.

“One day I realized I barely ate anything during my shift, then I got home starving and ate way more than I planned. If I had known how far behind I was earlier, I probably would've eaten another snack at work.”

• Follow-Up Probes

Follow-Up Probe: Is being under your target always a good thing when trying to lose weight?

“No, because if I barely eat all day, I get really hungry later and it's harder for me to control what I eat at night.”

Closing

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided

☒ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“My weight goal affected what I chose, but convenience affected it more.”

“If I barely eat all day, I get really hungry later.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Participant's irregular work schedule makes daily food tracking difficult and can lead to unintentionally eating too little earlier and overeating later.

8. Guided Interview Sheet – Interview 5

Print or copy one sheet per interview. Fill in the top sections before the conversation starts, and complete the synthesis section within twenty-four hours afterward.

Interview Information

Interviewer(s)	Samuel Alderete		
Date	09-07-2026	Time	12:40 PM
Location	UTEP Campus		
Phase (1 or 2)	Phase 1	Idea or problem area	Nutrition / Eating toward a body goal

Subject Information

Use a role or descriptor only. Do not record the subject's full name anywhere on this sheet.

Role or descriptor	Beginner weightlifter / college student
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How they were reached	In person
Relevant experience with the problem area	Recently began trying to gain muscle and increase protein intake
Consent to take notes given?	Yes
Consent to follow up later?	Yes

Body: Problem Exploration

Q1: Can you tell me about the last time you tried to lose or gain weight? Was there a body goal you had set for yourself?

“I started taking the gym more seriously a few months ago. I'm not really focused on a certain weight, but I want to gain muscle and get stronger without gaining too much fat.”

Q2: Tell me about the last time you tracked what you ate. How long did you keep it up?

“I tried tracking for probably a week. I entered my meals into an app, but I wasn't always sure if I was entering the right amounts.”

Q3: What made you stop?

“I didn't know the serving sizes for a lot of stuff. Especially when my family cooked, I didn't know how much oil, meat or anything else was used, so it felt like I was just guessing anyway.”

Q4: Walk me through how you decided what to eat yesterday. Did your goal factor into it?

“Yesterday I had cereal in the morning, grabbed food between classes and ate dinner at home. I thought about getting enough protein, but I didn't actually know how much protein or calories I had eaten until I thought about it later.”

Q5: Tell me about the last time you hit a target for a full week. What was different that week?

“I don't think I've actually hit everything for seven days straight. I've probably done four or five days. Usually the good days are when I'm at home and can make all my own food.”

Q6: Tell me about the last time you realized at the end of a day that you'd fallen short.

“A few days ago I thought I had eaten a lot, but when I added everything up I was still low on protein. I had enough calories, but a lot of them came from snacks.”

• Follow-Up Probes

Follow-Up Probe: What is the hardest part about knowing whether you're on track?

“I understand what my goal is, but I don't always know what meals I should eat to actually reach it.”

Closing

Referral name(s) or contact(s):

None provided

☒ Thanked them for their time

Post-Interview Synthesis (complete within 24 hours)

Exact quote(s) captured, word for word:

“I understand what my goal is, but I don't always know what meals I should eat to actually reach it.”

“I had enough calories, but a lot of them came from snacks.”

Did this conversation reveal a specific, repeatable problem? (Yes / No)

One-sentence takeaway:

Participant understands their general nutrition goal but has difficulty translating macro targets into actual meals and often realizes deficiencies only after eating.

App Candidate 3 (Event Tracker): Interview Responses

Questions	Tell me about the last event you went to in the El Paso/Juarez area. Follow up: How did you hear about it?	Where do you usually look when you want to find something to do on weekends or when you have free time in the El Paso/Juarez area? Follow up: Did you always know where to look? Follow up 2: How did you find these resources?	Is it easy to find things to do or places to go that are of your interest? Tell me about your experience. Follow up: Do you think they exist, but you just don't hear about them?	Tell me about the last time you told someone else about an event. How did you find that event?	Think about a time when you found out about an event too late, why do you think that happened? Follow up question: How often does this happen to you?
Interview 1	"The last one I went to was an event in Lost and Found; they were doing a collab with a bar in Juarez." "My friends"	"Probably Instagram or Tiktok." "No, if I am being honest, I am always getting invited because someone else looks them up (the events). But then I figured out that it's through FitFam that most people know about events here." "Through my family, when I moved here, they would ask me "oh did you see this on fitfam" and that kind of stuff."	"I don't think so, I think that since we are a little town some of my particular interests don't get as much exposure" "I've heard about them every once in a while recently, but since they are little bit more niche, most of the times I don't hear about them"	"I told my friend about a card show over the weekend, I saw it on a TikTok post"	"It was also a card show, I was talking to my co-worker about it and how I missed it last week and they mentioned that there would be another card show soon." Because I didn't actually look for it, I usually don't look for events, they just come to me on my feed, I don't actively look for events" "Not as often because I don't actively look for things to do, so I often just don't find out at all"

Interview 2	"The last public event that we went to was the 4th of July fireworks at the outlet shoppes" "A friend of ours told us if we wanted to see the fireworks"	"I'll probably be an outlier here, but my wife usually tells me about them because I don't have any social media. I have a ring camera, and they have communities' tabs that you can join and weirdly enough I have found out about things happening around my neighborhood through there, but it is very rarely that people post there "	"Not really, it is not easy to find events relevant to my interests; since I don't have social media, I don't have an easy way to get to this information, I would have really really to look for it on google" "Even if they existed I don't think I would find out about them"	"Yes, I have a friend that wanted to get vaccines for their puppy and very coincidentally I found a vaccines event through the Ring app, so screenshotted it and texted it to my friend"	"There was a Little Jesus concert in Juarez, and I didn't find out about it until it had already happened. At the time I did have a Facebook account, but I think I still didn't find out about the concert because I wasn't following the band and maybe that's why I didn't get notified that they were playing in Juarez. I think it's because I wasn't following the right channels or people" "I wouldn't say this happens often to me"
Interview 3	"The last event I went to was a thrift market." "My sister told me about it"	"Instagram" "No" "I started following different coffee shops, flower shops that organized different events, and overall things I liked and Instagram just started showing me stuff that I was interested in, but I needed to look for the stuff first and then the app would start showing similar things to me."	"No, I end up going to the same places over and over again because there is nothing new that is interesting to me, or at least it's not popping up" "Yes"	"I told my boyfriend, sister and coworkers about a Matcha event that will happen in Juarez and I found out about it because I go to that matcha place a lot and because they posted about it too"	"It happens because there is no one that informs me about it, there is nothing that lets me see and learn about new stuff happening in the area" "It happens more often than I would like it to"

Interview 4	"It was like a Bazar/market for entrepreneurs that work in the food and dessert industry, and it was held near Sunland Park" "My godmother told me"	"Usually through Instagram" "No" "By following small businesses, they usually announce their markets through posts on social media"	"Yes it has been easy for me because I am constantly looking up stuff that interests me and that I like; I join many online communities too and leading me to follow different pages that offer similar events, which has made it easier for me to find things to do"	"I found a new matcha place through Instagram, I started getting a lot of review posts about it and I told my cousins about it"	"A store that I like was hosting a little market but I found out about it way too late." I think I missed it because I wasn't on social media too much at the time." "It happens to me often"
Interview 5	"It was Karol G's concert" "I heard of it because of FitFam"	"I usually don't look for events, usually someone else tells me about them"	"Unless it's a bazar/market you don't really hear about any other thing and usually they are not of my interest and if they are they are usually too far away or they are hosted during weekdays so it makes it harder to go "	"It was probably a year ago the last time I told someone about an event, I have noticed that I only hear about very big events like concerts, but even then only when really famous artists are coming to town." I heard about it through social media and because I was following the band's account, I didn't see anything advertised on El Paso's websites or anything"	"The Steve Aoki dj set." I think I missed it because I don't often look for events of social media so I tend to miss them; unless I am following the artists directly." "Not really"

Interview 6	"The last event I went to was a public party" "My friend told me about the party, but it was also posted on a facebook group"	"I usually look in Instagram or Facebook's events section" "Not really, its mostly by chance if I ever come across something, I don't even know what to look for most of the times" "I have found the resources through the apps themselves, they have an events' tab and I can get notified if my friends are planning to go to the events "	"I don't think it's that easy because I know there are events I can look forward to, but I don't really see any advertisements for them and I don't really look for events either " "Yes because the events that I'd look forwards to are held by subcultures that are present in every city, but I just haven't heard enough of them or haven't looked for them either."	"The last time I told someone about an event it was also a party and I heard about it through acquaintances or social media"	"I missed a concert. I missed it because I wasn't aware of it sooner and I didn't have the time to save up some money and buy a ticket." "Not too often because I end up not hearing about the events at all, so I don't even notice I miss them "
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App Candidate 4 (Market Master): Interview Responses

Questions	How many investment assets do you own?	What do you know about the stock market?	How much capital do you think it takes to invest in the stock market?	What's your biggest concern or fear about investing in the stock market?	Have you ever used an investing education app before? If so, what did you like or dislike about it?	What would motivate you to use an investing education app regularly?
Interview 1	"0. I don't have any money in stocks right now."	"Honestly, nothing. I just know that you can buy and sell stocks on apps and stuff like that."	"I feel like you need at least \$1,000 to \$2,000 upfront for it to even be worth doing."	"Losing a bunch of money because I don't know what I'm doing."	"Not an investing education app, but I did try Robinhood."	"I think as long as it's intuitive, I would try it out."
Interview 2	"Just a company 401k that my employer automatically enrolled me in."	"Not much really, I know prices go up and down based on the economy or news."	"Maybe \$500 to get started?"	"Market crashes. I work hard for my paycheck, so the idea of watching my account drop like 20% in a week gives me anxiety."	"Never used one."	"I think if it can clearly explain things to beginners I would try it out."

Interview3	"I have a tiny bit of crypto on Coinbase, nothing too crazy."	" Just the basics. I follow a few stock market accounts on Instagram and TikTok."	" I'd say you can start with about \$50-\$100."	" I think getting FOMO on trends, but also getting caught in a pump and dump."	" I downloaded an app once that was kind of like flash cards, but that's about it."	"I think interactive visual charts where you can see different stocks."
Interview4	" None. My friends and family always said that it's gambling and that it's better to keep it in a savings."	" I know about wall street, but I have no idea how buying a stock actually works or what you own when you buy one."	" At least \$5000? Aren't stocks like really expensive?"	" Losing my emergency savings because I don't know what I'm doing."	"Never tried one."	" If it clearly proves to me step by step that I won't lose all my money."
Interview5	" I think my job has a retirement account for me, but I've never logged in to look at it or anything."	" I know you can buy shares of companies like Amazon and Google, but I don't know how you even make money off of that."	" \$1000 minimum."	" The time spent having to research and learn everything while having to work. It's like a second full-time job."	" I downloaded one once, but there was too much finance jargon, I didn't know what I was reading."	" I think short interactive lessons would make it easy to not get distracted, and not so much finance jargon."

App Candidate 5 (Searching across streaming services): Interview Responses

Questions	How many streaming services are you paying for right now?	When was the last time you cancelled one? What made you cancel?	Tell me about the last time you gave up on finding something to watch and did something else instead.	Walk me through how you found the last new show you started.	Tell me about the last time you rented or bought something digitally instead of watching it on a service you already pay for. What led to that?
Interview 1	"I have Four. Netflix, Hulu, Disney+, and Prime."	"I cancelled HBO Max back in March. I only got it for The Last of Us."	"Last Sunday I think? I scrolled Netflix for maybe twenty minutes, nothing looked good, and I ended up on Youtube."	"A guy at work would not stop talking about Severance, so I looked it up and it was on Apple TV, which I didn't have. So I did the free trial."	"I rented Dune 2 on Prime for like six bucks. Found out later it was on Max, which my girlfriend pays for. That one bugged me."

Interview2	“Netflix, Disney+, and Peacock.”	“Peacock, but then I resubscribed for the Olympics and never cancelled again. The first time I dropped it was because I saw the charge on my card and realized I hadn’t opened it in two months.”	“I don’t remember when, but my husband and I went back and forth for half an hour and then put on The Office again. That’s our default when nobody wants to decide.”	“So I think it was that Someone posted a clip on Tiktok, I searched the name, and it happened to be on Netflix so I started it that night.”	“We bought Inside Out 2 on YouTube because my daughter kept asking, and it wasn’t on Disney+ yet. It showed up there about two months later.”
Interview3	“Technically I have none. I use my mom’s Netflix mostly.”	“I think it was Crunchyroll over the summer. I was watching one show a week and it stopped being worth it.”	“I went through Netflix one time and by the time I picked something it was midnight, so I went to bed instead.”	“Someone dropped a link for The Bear in our group chat. Been watching that ever since.”	“I paid four dollars for a movie on Apple because I wanted it that night and didn’t feel like checking anywhere else. I probably could have waited.”
Interview4	“Netflix and Prime. Also, my son put something else on the TV but I don’t know what it is.”	“I don’t think I’ve ever cancelled one. My wife handles what subscriptions we have, I just follow along.”	“That happens a lot. I sit down after dinner, look at the screen for a while, and end up reading instead.”	“My brother-in-law brought up Landman at a barbecue. It took me a while to figure out where it was, Paramount I think, and I never got around to watching it.”	“I bought Top Gun Maverick on the TV for about twenty dollars. It was right there on the screen and I pressed the button. I didn’t check if I already had it somewhere.”
Interview5	“Netflix, HBO Max, Hulu, Paramount+, and Apple TV.”	“I think it was Paramount+. Right after the first season of a show I can’t remember ended. Then I resubscribed in the during seasons later. I cycle it on and off.”	“Literally yesterday. I checked Netflix, then Max, then Hulu, and after the third one I gave up.”	“I think it was a Reddit thread about underrated shows. Someone mentioned The Leftovers, I checked, and it was already on HBO Max.”	“I rented Anatomy of a Fall on Amazon and my roommate told me the next day it was on Hulu, which I pay for. So I wasted money for nothing.”